



Sahara Desert, Africa

Hot deserts

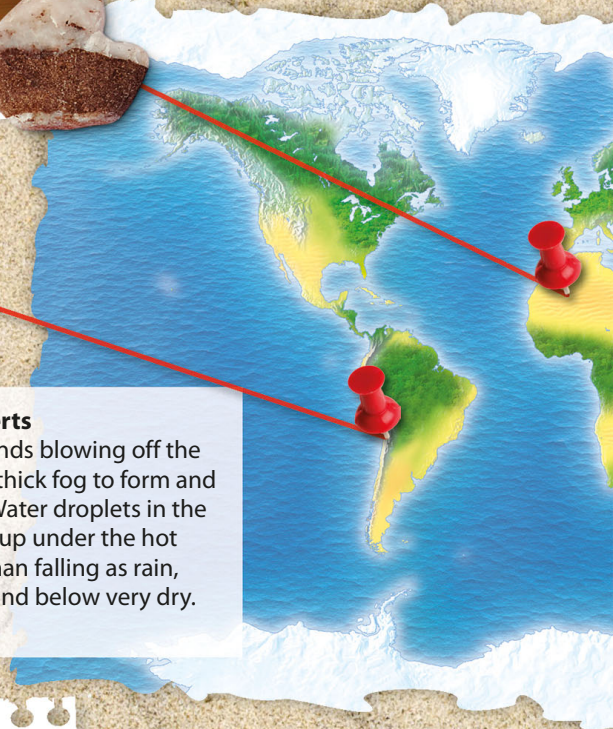
Temperatures often reach 50°C (122°F) or higher during the day in hot deserts. But at night, it can be very cold. Most hot deserts are near the equator, where there is strong sunlight all year round.



Atacama Desert, South America

Coastal deserts

Here, cold winds blowing off the ocean cause thick fog to form and drift inland. Water droplets in the fog soon dry up under the hot Sun, rather than falling as rain, leaving the land below very dry.



Deserts

About a third of Earth's surface is covered by deserts. They are areas that get little or no rain, so they are extremely dry. Only a few species of animals and plants can survive in them. We usually think of deserts as very hot places, but some are very cold.

! WOW!

The largest desert, the Sahara, covers about a **quarter** of Africa!